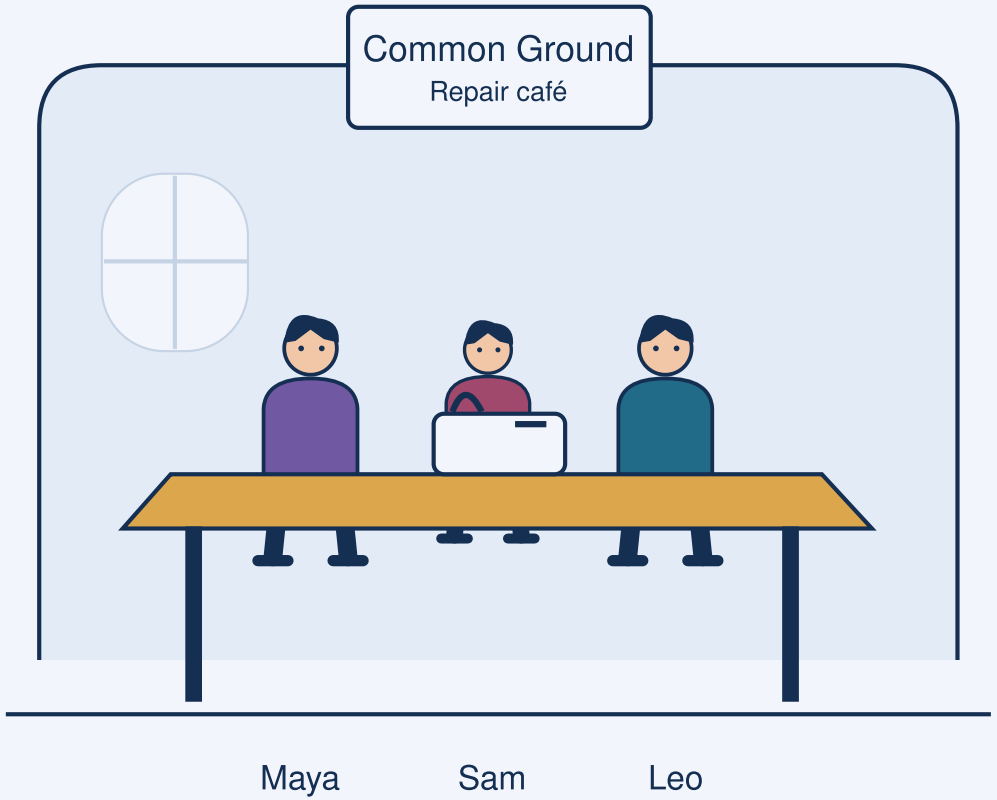
“Anyone can join.” The form says otherwise.

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.



A fictional story. A real question about people.

What would you do?

How should the team investigate unequal access?

A Ask whether organizers consider themselves fair.

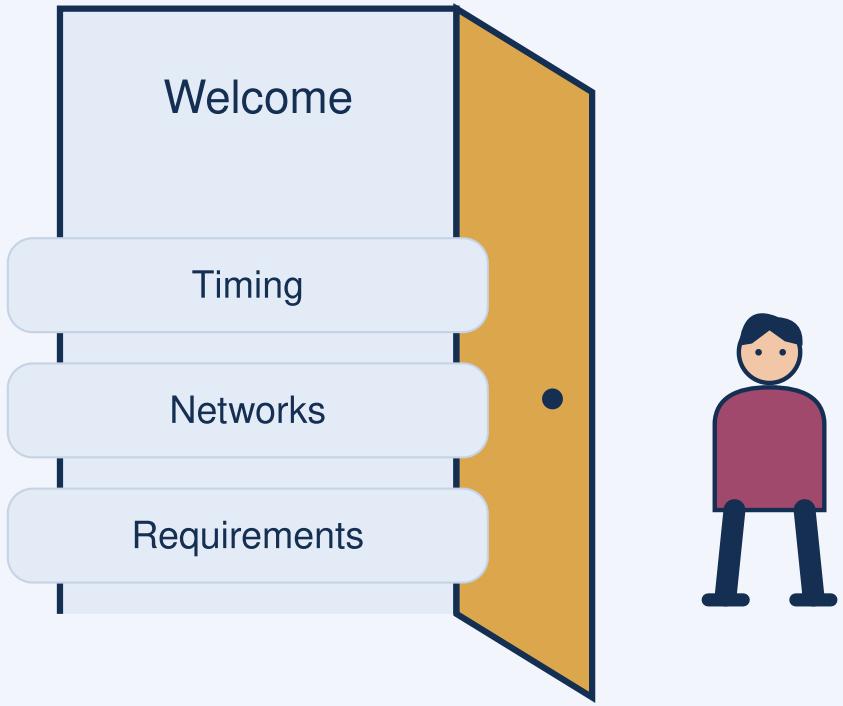
B Trace who can enter each stage and where people drop out.

C Add a fairness slogan to the poster.

Suggested answer: B. A process audit can reveal barriers that intentions and slogans miss.

Belief, feeling, and action are distinct.

- Stereotype: a generalized group belief.
- Prejudice: an evaluative attitude toward a group.
- Discrimination: unequal treatment based on group membership.

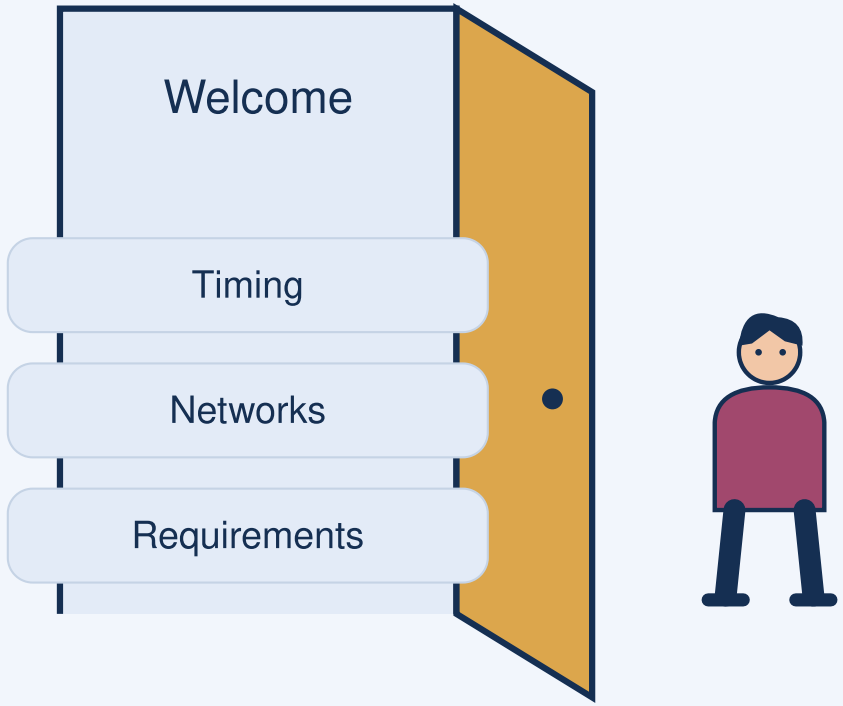


Good intentions do not remove every barrier.

Timing, networks, and requirements can restrict access.

Change the encounter and the structure.

- Use relevant, consistent criteria.
- Remove unnecessary access barriers.
- Support cooperation and meaningful participation.

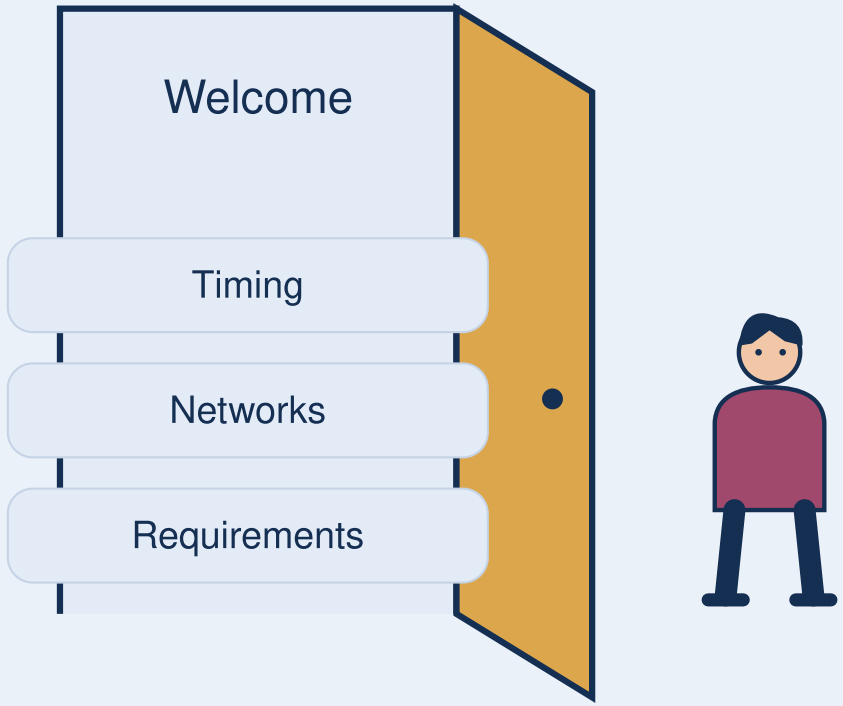


Good intentions do not remove every barrier.

Timing, networks, and requirements can restrict access.

What can we really conclude?

Explicit attitudes, implicit associations, and discriminatory behavior are different measures. A test score is not a complete character diagnosis or a forecast of every action. Evaluate interventions using meaningful behavior and access outcomes, follow-up, and affected people's experiences. Account for small samples and protect privacy; measuring inequality does not justify collecting unnecessary personal information.



Good intentions do not remove every barrier.

Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

Try the idea somewhere new.

Friend referrals become an open skills-based application. How can improvement be assessed?

A Check whether organizers feel more inclusive.

B Compare the friendliness of form wording.

C Track applications, progression, and participation using relevant criteria.

Suggested answer: C. Stage-by-stage outcomes can reveal remaining barriers; interpret with context and privacy safeguards.

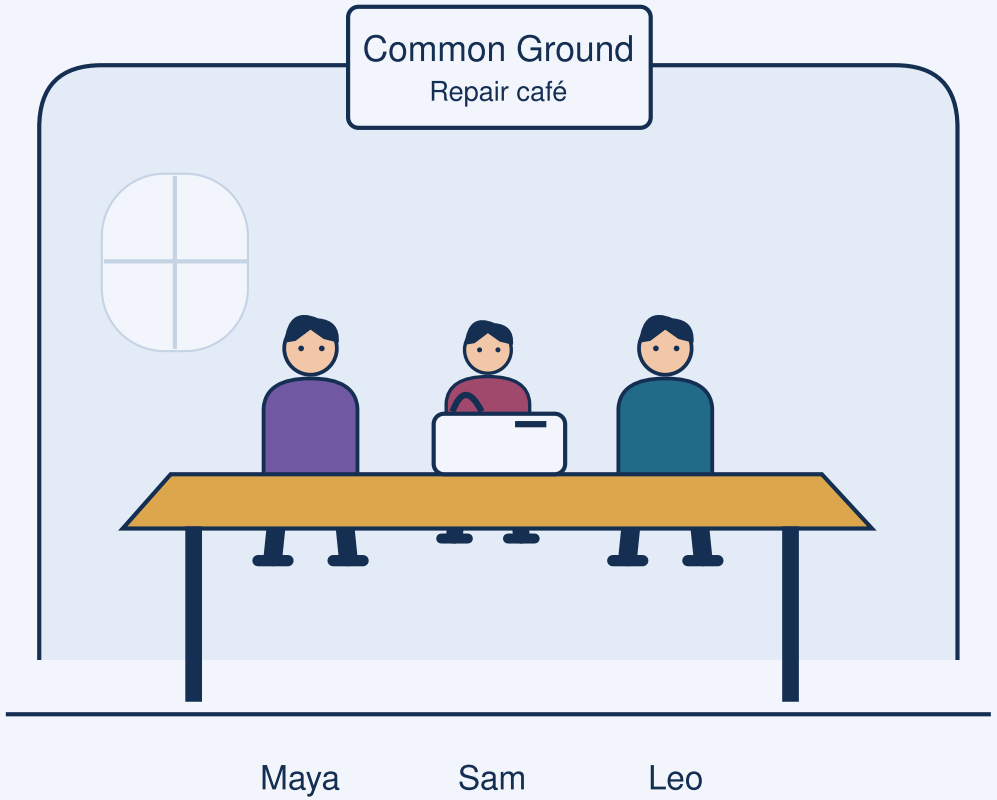
Close your notes. Explain it.

> Give discrimination without open hostility as an example.

> Why might a contact event leave unequal access unchanged?

1. An irrelevant requirement or restricted network can exclude a group without a hostile statement.

2. Power, incentives, status differences, or procedures may stay unchanged.

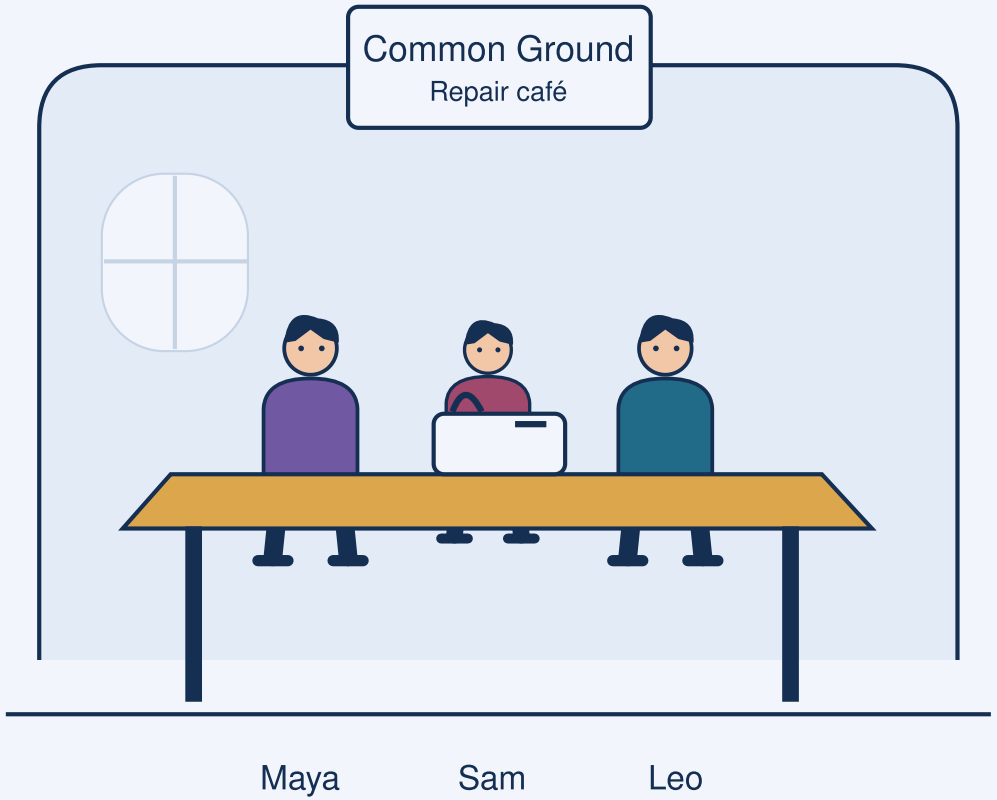


Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

Carry one idea into your week.

Review a process you are authorized to examine. Identify an unnecessary barrier, propose a change, and select a fair outcome measure without collecting unnecessary personal data.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.



Take the question into a different setting.